

Preface

Group Counseling: Strategies and Skills, Eighth Edition, provides an in-depth look at group counseling with an emphasis on practical knowledge and techniques for effective group leadership. For this edition, we are excited to include additional videos that bring to life the skills presented in this textbook. For the seventh edition we made 43 short videos showing specific skills. The new clips show an integration of many skills and techniques. The book and video clips are for counselors, social workers, psychologists, and others who are leading groups in a variety of settings. Our active approach to group leadership reflects a belief that the leader is primarily responsible for the planning and implementing of the group. We have found that in most settings—schools, hospitals, rehabilitation facilities, and mental health centers—the leader must take a very active part in facilitating the group. In this book, we offer a reader-friendly, practical, how-to group text. This book is written for students.

Throughout the book and in the videos we discuss and demonstrate many different kinds of groups. The examples offered help the reader understand how an effective leader utilizes both basic and advanced leadership skills. We integrate the skills and examples described in the text with the role-play demonstrations presented in the videos.

We recognize that group leadership is one of the most difficult forms of counseling performed by therapists, school counselors, drug and alcohol counselors, correctional counselors, nurses, and others in the helping professions. Our goal is to bridge the gap between theory and practice. We present a sophisticated how-to approach for both beginning students and experienced practitioners. In each chapter we address the needs of counselors, social workers, correctional officers, ministers, nurses, and others who may be reading this book. The purpose of the text and videos is to integrate traditional theories and concepts of group process with thoughtful strategies and specific skills.

Other Changes and Additions to this Edition

In this Eighth Edition we have also made the following changes and additions:

1. We have updated references throughout the text to reflect current concepts and research findings relevant to group process.
2. We eliminated Chapter 18. We put some of the content from Chapter 18 in appropriate chapters.
3. We have moved the section on legal issues from Chapter 18 to Chapter 1. This change is in response to feedback from a number of consumers and reviewers who felt that learning about ethical considerations regarding group work should come at the beginning of the book.
4. We moved the coleading section from Chapter 18 to Chapter 6. We added a video on coleading.
5. We moved evaluation of groups from Chapter 18 to Chapter 3.
6. We add segments on motivational interviewing in Chapter 13 and on working with military groups in Chapter 17.
7. We added longer videos so the viewer could see the skills being used in the beginning, middle, and closing phases of sessions. Also the viewer will see the members and theories used in a variety of ways that help make groups more engaging.

Organization

Our readers, from time to time, have suggested a reorganization of the chapters to flow more with their individual teaching or learning styles. We have considered such changes with each revision, but have concluded that instructors vary in their use of the text based on their previous experience with teaching the group course. It would be nice if we could offer various arrangements to the chapters depending on how the book is going to be utilized; but because we cannot, we chose the order that seems to work well for many. Readers who are currently leading groups usually go to the chapters that are relevant for their immediate needs.

Our own approach has been to teach an overview that includes basic skills, planning, beginning groups, advanced skills and techniques, and finally approaches for closing a group. The last two chapters cover problem members and special populations—many educators have students read these chapters during the first couple of weeks of the semester.

Specifically, the three opening chapters provide an overview of group leadership. In these chapters, we examine various kinds of groups, leadership styles, uses of current theories, group dynamics, therapeutic forces in groups, group process, and the purpose of groups. In Chapter 1, we introduce our approach to group leadership based on the principles of impact therapy, which is an active,

multisensory approach to counseling. Also in Chapter 1 we present a clear picture of different approaches to leading groups and discuss in detail the differences between the interpersonal and intrapersonal approaches to leading. We have also moved the sections on legal and ethical issues in group counseling to this chapter so that the reader becomes grounded in the importance of following ethical guidelines. Chapter 2 focuses on the importance of understanding therapeutic forces, including those presented by Yalom (2005). Chapter 3 emphasizes the importance of clarity of purpose, which is a key element in the successful outcome of nearly any kind of group. We demonstrate this in the three videos on clarity of purpose.

Chapters 4, 5, and 6 cover a range of both basic and advanced leadership skills for planning and implementing a group, as well as specific strategies and skills for initiating the first and second sessions of a group. Chapter 4 is on planning groups. Included in the chapter on planning are sample plans with a detailed discussion of each plan. Chapter 5, which focuses on the first and second sessions of a group, describes the many different things a leader must consider in the first sessions. We provide numerous examples of how to begin various kinds of groups. We also present techniques for the introduction of members and the introduction of a new member during the second or subsequent sessions. Three videos on beginning groups are provided. Chapter 6 focuses on basic skills of group leading. Summarizing, clarifying, and using one's eyes in effective ways are among the skills discussed. Three videos are on basic skills. We also discuss coleading and provide a video showing two leaders working together.

Chapter 7 affirms the importance of establishing, holding, and deepening the focus in a group. We present creative ways to "get the focus" and a discussion of the depth chart, which is a tool for monitoring the depth of a session. Six videos are presented regarding the focus of the group. Chapter 8 offers techniques for skillfully drawing out quiet members and cutting off members who ramble or otherwise diffuse the focus of the group. We provide seven visual segments on these two concepts.

The essential uses of rounds and dyads are outlined and illustrated by numerous examples in Chapter 9. Three video segments focus on different kinds of rounds. Other exercises are discussed extensively in Chapters 10 and 11. Written, movement, fantasy, and creative exercises are among those reviewed in these chapters. Techniques are presented for introducing and processing the exercises, along with ethical considerations, and specific cautions for using them. We provide four visual segments that show effective use of exercises.

Chapter 12 is devoted to the strategies and skills important to the critical middle sessions of a group. We offer a way for the leader to prepare for dealing with topics during the middle sessions. We discuss four topics in detail: sex, need for approval, religion, and self-esteem. We also address issues of trust and commitment, common mistakes some leaders make during this period, and various strategies for increasing the group's effectiveness. Chapter 13 is on the use of counseling theories in groups. We offer brief descriptions of nine theories and many examples on how the theories can be used in groups. We provide many videos that show the effective use of theories in a group.

Chapter 14 focuses specifically on skills and techniques essential for leading therapy groups. We discuss the role and responsibilities of the leader, the process of therapy, specific techniques, and common mistakes. We also outline ways of conducting therapy with a member while involving all the other members. We have created many videos that relate to Chapter 14.

Chapter 15 contains techniques for closing sessions and groups. We have five examples of closing on the various videos. Chapter 16 offers strategies for handling problem members (the chronic talker and the negative member, for example) and situations (such as resistance, sexual feelings, and conflicts between members). Chapter 17 deals with issues specific to certain populations, such as children, adolescents, couples, older people, and those who are chemically dependent, divorced, survivors of sexual abuse, and adult children of alcoholics. In the videos we varied the kinds of groups so there are segments with kids, teenagers, and those in treatment centers. We conclude the book with the encouragement to watch the videos numerous times, especially the last five where many skills and techniques are utilized.

To simplify the presentation, we use *he* and *she* alternately to represent the leader and group members. We also use the terms *counseling* and *therapy* interchangeably.

Supplements for Students and Instructors

DVD and Video. In addition to the core book, the Eighth Edition of *Group Counseling: Strategies and Skills* can be bundled with new videos highlighting topic-specific group counseling skills along with over 40 videos that demonstrate many different group leadership skills. The videos found in the DVD are also available online through the Group Counseling: Strategies and Skills CourseMate website.

Cengage Learning Testing, powered by Cognero Instant Access. Cognero is a flexible, online system that allows you to author, edit, and manage test bank content as well as create multiple test versions in an instant. You can deliver tests from your school's learning management system, your classroom, or wherever you want.

Online Instructor's Manual. The Instructor's Manual (IM) contains a variety of resources to aid instructors in preparing and presenting text material in a manner that meets their personal preferences, and course needs. It presents chapter-by-chapter suggestions and resources to enhance and facilitate learning.

Online PowerPoint®. These vibrant Microsoft® PowerPoint® lecture slides for each chapter assist you with your lecture by providing concept coverage using materials directly from the textbook.

CourseMate. Available with the text, Cengage Learning's CourseMate brings course concepts to life with interactive learning, study, and exam

preparation tools that support the printed textbook. CourseMate includes an integrated eBook, glossaries, flashcards, quizzes, videos, and more—as well as Engagement Tracker, a first-of-its-kind tool that monitors student engagement in the course.

Helping Professions Learning Center 2-Semester Instant Access Code. Designed to help you bridge the gap between coursework and practice, the Helping Professions Learning Center (HPLC) offers a centralized online resource that allows you to build your skills and gain even more confidence and familiarity with the principles that govern the life of the helping professional. The interactive site consists of six learning components: Video Activities organized by curriculum area and accompanied by critical thinking questions; Ethics, Diversity, and Theory-based Case Studies; Flashcards and Practice Quizzes; a Professional Development Center, and a Research and Writing Center.

Acknowledgments

We wish to express our appreciation to our many friends and students who contributed ideas and insights to the Eighth Edition of this book. We also in particular wish to thank those who participated in the role-plays for the video clips, both as leaders and as members. Although the authors provided guidelines regarding the issues to explore in each role-play, the participants presented these roles in such a way as to create very realistic scenarios.

We also want to express our appreciation to the many workshop participants who shared with us the difficulties inherent in leading groups in the field. Their insights have done much to guide the development of our thinking through these eight editions.

We want to also thank the reviewers who encouraged us to assess various sections of the book. We continue to try to make each edition better based on the different suggestions of the reviewers. Our sincere thanks go to:

Susannah Coaston, Northern Kentucky University

Kimberly Desmond, Indiana University of Pennsylvania

Lorraine Guth, Indiana University of Pennsylvania

James Hall, Montgomery College

Jonathan Lent, Marshall University

Karin Lindstrom Bremer, Minnesota State University – Mankato

Tommy Lopez, Central Piedmont Community College

Evelyn Lyles, University of Maryland

Lauren Wynne, Georgia State University

We also want to thank Julie Martinez and Wendy Langerud, our editors, for their help in seeing that the book got published in a timely fashion and for being

such helpful people to work with. Special thanks go out to Julie for seeing the value of having a second DVD as a supplement to text and then doing all the hard work to see that the DVD project happened. Finally, we want to thank all the people at Brooks/Cole who worked on this project—you are a great group of people to work with.

Ed E. Jacobs
Christine Schimmel
Robert L. Masson
Riley L. Harvill